

Unit 7: Retroflex and z

1 In this unit

Hard ڈ vs soft ڑ; ڙ the flapped r that never starts a word; ز; the rare Persian ژ.

How long: About 2.5 hours for a child, 1 for an adult. Do 10 minutes a day, short and happy.



2 What to say and show, letter by letter

	Say	How the pen moves	Often mixed up with
ڙ	دال دال dāl hard English 'd' in dad, tongue curled back	top down and out to the left in one angled stroke, then the small ط sign on top, last	dāl
ڑ	ڑے re a flapped 'r'/'d' made with the tongue curled back (no English match)	top down and sweep left below the line, then the small ط sign on top, last	re, ze
ز	زے ze 'z' in zoo	top down and sweep left below the line; the dot last	re, ڑe, zhe
ژ	ژے zhe 's' in pleasure (Persian loanwords only, rare)	top down and sweep left below the line; the dots last	ze, re

3 How to use the sheets

- Trace and write:** one page per letter. Start at the dot, follow the arrow; body first, dots last.
- Look-alikes:** circle the same letter, then sort by dots.
- Join the letters:** standing letters into a joined word.
- Read and match:** word to meaning.
- Reading practice:** words, sentences, story.
- Dictation:** the grown-up says it, the child writes it.
- Unit check:** 10 questions. The answer key is the last page of the unit-check PDF; in the unit pack the keys are on the last pages.

4 How to check

- Letters:** cover the sound, point to the letter, the child says it. 3 of 4 right is a pass.
- Writing:** look at the start dot and the direction, not at how pretty it is. Right to left, body first, dots last.
- Unit check:** 8 of 10 means go on. Under 8: redo the look-alike and trace sheets, try again tomorrow.
- Praise effort:** "you started on the right", "good dots". One sheet a day beats five at once.

5 A 10-minute sitting

2 min warm-up: point to last time's letters, the child says them. **5 min** the sheet of the day: say it, trace it, write it. **3 min** read it back together and end on something done well.